A great feature in PactFlow is the stub functionality, which enables contracts to be used as a stub via a direct URL, as shown in figure 9.13. Within PactFlow, all contracts are automatically allocated a hosted API stub URL. The functionality is also available within open source by spinning up a stub server locally.

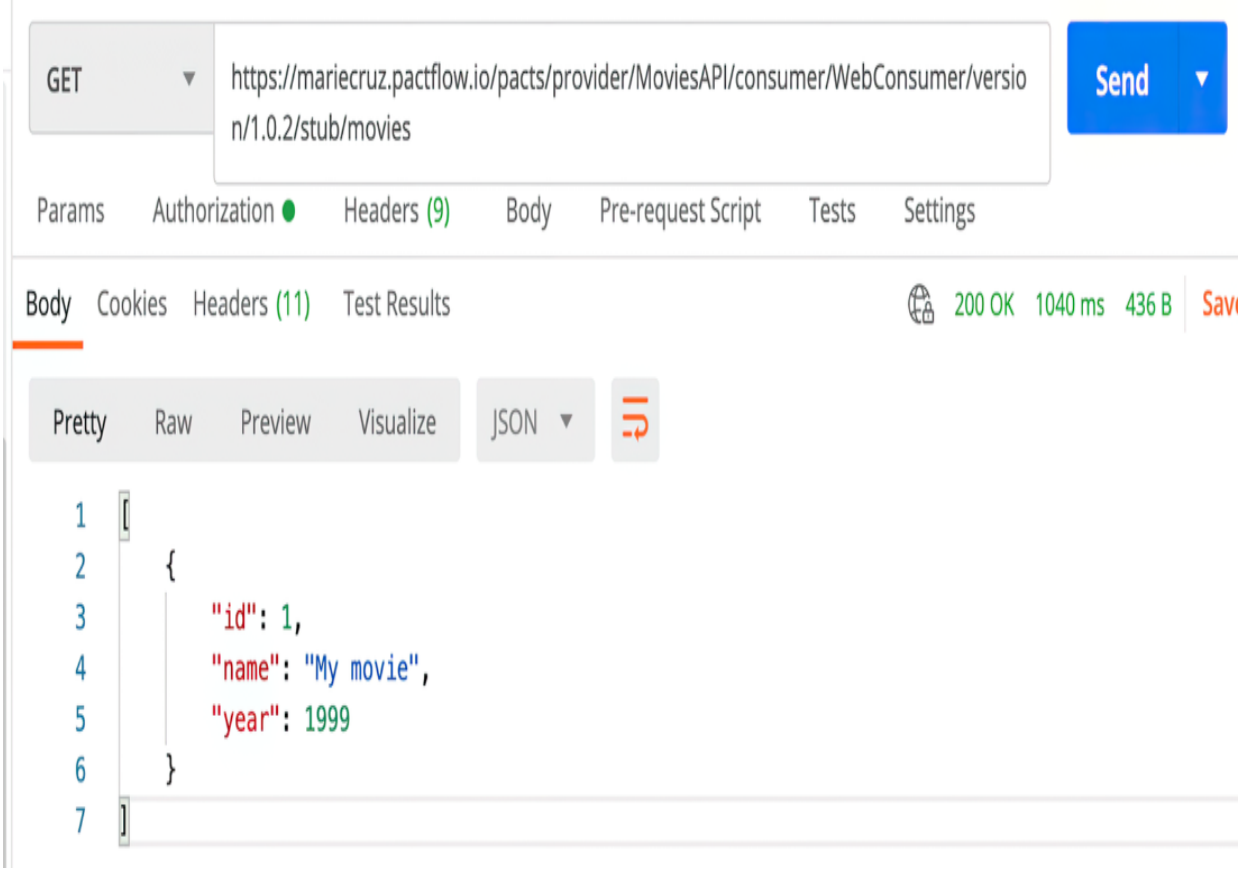


Figure 9.13 Postman request to the `MoviesAPI` provider stub, which returns a response based on the consumer contract

There are a couple of different scenarios where we see this being used in a software development project. When developing frontend and backend services in parallel, a consumer-driven contract stub can be used. While developing the frontend part, the stub can be used, and as soon as the backend service is available, they can verify the contract, which also verifies the stub. Within the unit tests for the frontend, the stub could be used where a mock response would usually be. Another suite of tests that could benefit from contract stubs is the end-to-end test suite. When end-to-end tests mock out external services to check the frontend application in isolation, static mocks are created. End-to-end tests with contract stubs